Six of nine associate-degree programs enter review in 2027

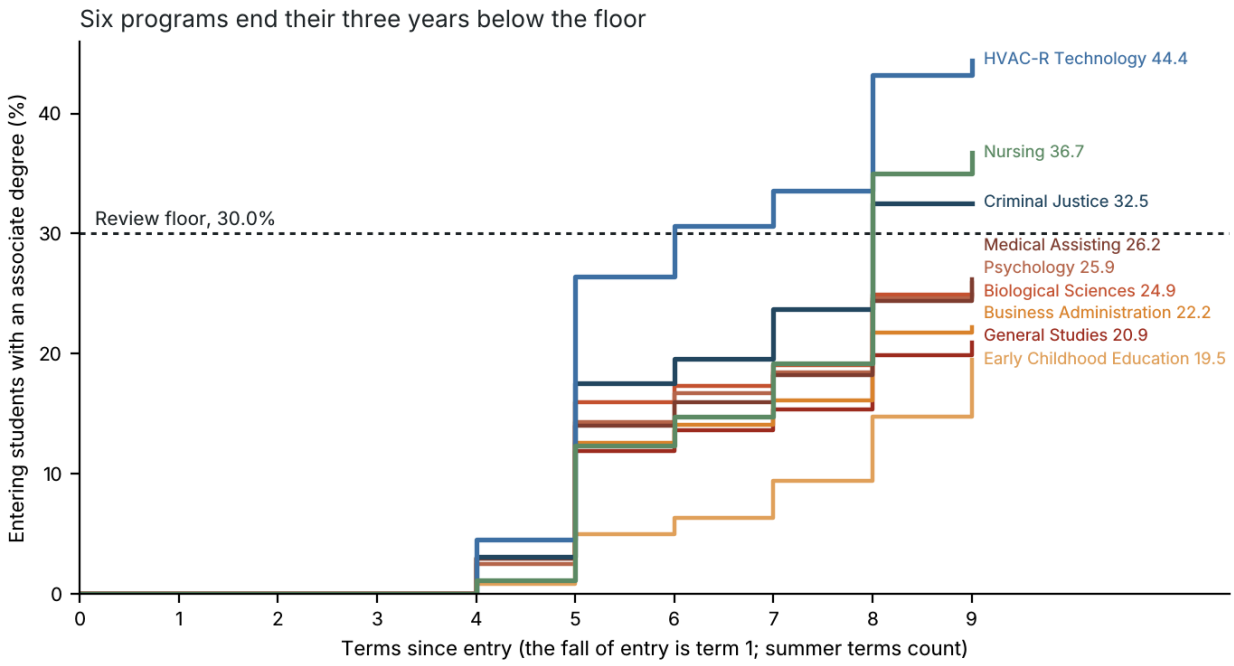
Board of Trustees, regular meeting of 17 June 2027, agenda item 7.2: Academic program review (Board Policy 3.12). From Tammy Weaver, Director of Institutional Research; through Derek Collier, Vice President for Academic Affairs. 4 June 2027.

Recommendation

That the board place six programs in review from 2027-28: General Studies, Biological Sciences, Business Administration, Psychology, Medical Assisting and Early Childhood Education. Their three-year completion shares, 20.9, 24.9, 22.2, 25.9, 26.2 and 19.5 per cent, are below the policy's floor of 30 per cent of entering students earning an associate degree within three years. Criminal Justice (32.5 per cent), HVAC-R Technology (44.4) and Nursing (36.7) stay out of review.

Program	Entering students	Three-year completion (%)	Review	FTE, fall 2026	Classes under ten
General Studies	1,594	20.9	Yes	1,164.1	1
Biological Sciences	470	24.9	Yes	358.0	13
Business Administration	765	22.2	Yes	531.7	5
Psychology	516	25.9	Yes	404.0	5
Medical Assisting	406	26.2	Yes	386.6	9
Early Childhood Education	341	19.5	Yes	343.6	3
Criminal Justice	484	32.5	No	397.1	3
HVAC-R Technology	265	44.4	No	274.5	13
Nursing	446	36.7	No	538.3	78

Sources: IR fall entering-student files; registrar's admissions extract, conferrals, fall 2026 registrations, schedule and program history, 28 May 2027.



How the share is measured

The policy counts every student who entered in fall 2023, 2024 or 2025, including the two classes still inside their three years. Each admission ends with a degree, a transfer to another institution or a withdrawal, or is still open. For each program we take, term by term, the share of the admissions still open that ended in a degree in that term, weighted by the share of the class still open; a student who transferred out or withdrew has ended the admission without the college's degree, and only the admissions still open at the end of spring 2027 are carried forward on the rates of the classes observed in the later terms. Treating transfers and withdrawals as students whose outcome is still unknown would credit each of them with a share of a degree they can no longer earn here: it puts every program except Early Childhood Education above the floor, the transfer-oriented programs at 35 to 41 per cent.

The fall 2023 class, the only one whose three years have closed, is not the measure: the guided-pathways advising begun in fall 2024 has cut first-year withdrawals, and on that class alone Criminal Justice (26.8 per cent) would also enter review.

Review profile

FTE counts the credit hours registered at the fall 2026 census by each program's students, every course at its section credit hours, divided by 15. Classes under ten counts the program's own sections that ran in fall 2026 with fewer than ten students at the census, sections taught together over interactive video counted once. 77 of Nursing's 78 are clinical groups, which take at most eight students each.

Notes. Students who died (5) are removed from the classes. Shares are rounded to one decimal place; the floor applies to the unrounded share. The workbook program_completion_review_2027.xlsx has each program's share by term.